

UIL Literary Criticism 2026-2027 Reading List

Anne Bradstreet's Poems

Because editorial decisions across the years dictate spellings and grammatical conventions and because many of Anne Bradstreet's poems have titles that are very similar, the correct sourcing of her poems on the internet might best be ensured by including the first line of each of the selected poems.

TITLE AS IT APPEARS IN BELKNAP ANTHOLOGY	FIRST LINE OF POEM
"The Prologue"	To sing of Wars, of Captains, and of Kings
"In Honour of that High and Mighty Princess, Queen Elizabeth"	Although great Queen, thou now in silence lie
"The Flesh and the Spirit"	In secret place where once I stood
"The Vanity of All Worldly Things"	As he said vanity, so vain say I
"The Author to Her Book"	Thou ill-form'd offspring of my feeble brain
"Before the Birth of One of Her Children"	All things within this fading world hath end
"To My Dear and Loving Husband"	If ever two were one, then surely we
"A Letter to Her Husband, Absent upon Public Employment"	My head, my heart, mine eyes, my life, nay more
"To Her Father with Some Verses"	Most truly honoured, and as truly dear
"In Reference to her Children, 23 June, 1659"	I had eight birds hatched in one nest
"By Night when Others Soundly Slept" [all four quatrains]	By night when others soundly slept
"For Deliverance from a Fever"	When Sorrowes had begirt me round
"Meditations Divine and Moral" [prose piece: all 77 mediations]	https://bradstreetmeditations.wordpress.com/